



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

śrutvā tataḥ strī+jana+vallabhānām* |
mano+jña+bhāvaṃ* pura+kānanānām |
bahiḥ+prayāṇāya cakāra buddhim |
antar+grhe nāga* iva*avaruddhaḥ ||3.2|

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Having heard the delightful sounds and experiencing the captivating allure of the city's pleasure gardens, Siddhartha Gautama, like a mighty serpent confined within the inner chambers of his palace, resolved to journey beyond its walls. This verse speaks to the inherent human desire to transcend limitations, both internal and external. Siddhartha, though surrounded by luxury and comfort, felt a deep yearning for something more, a pull towards the unknown that resonated within his very being. The "delightful sounds" and "captivating allure" represent the sensory pleasures of the world, the very things that often bind us to a life of superficiality.

The image of the serpent restrained "antar+grhe," within the inner house, vividly illustrates the feeling of being trapped by circumstance, by societal expectations, or even by your own self-imposed limitations. We, too, often find ourselves confined within our own "inner houses" – prisons of our making – built from fear, doubt, and attachment. Perhaps your inner house is a career that no longer fulfills you, a relationship that stifles your growth, or a belief system that no longer serves your highest good.

Siddhartha's decision to venture "bahiḥ+prayāṇāya," outwards, demonstrates the courage needed to break free from these confines. It's a call to action, a reminder that true growth lies beyond the familiar and comfortable. Embracing the unknown requires a willingness to confront your fears and to step outside your comfort zone, just as Siddhartha did. This verse urges you to examine your own life and identify the areas where you feel constrained. What "inner houses" are holding you back from realizing your full potential? What are the "delightful sounds" that distract you from your true path? Dare to listen to the call of your own heart, the yearning for something more profound, and like Siddhartha, resolve to journey beyond the walls that confine you. Remember, the path to enlightenment begins with a single step outwards.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "inner house" holds you captive, and what small step can you take today to venture beyond its walls?